

TUDOR POPA

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EDUCATION

Babeş-Bolyai University

BS Computer Science, Mathematics

Oct 2006 – May 2009

Cluj-Napoca, Cluj, Romania

Horea, Cloşca şi Crişan High School

Informatics, Mathematics

Sep 2002 – Jun 2006

Alba-Iulia, Alba, Romania

WORK EXPERIENCE

Microsoft

Principal Software Engineering Manager

January 2022 – Present

Prague, Czechia

- Lead a Customer Experience team of 6 engineers in the Office Product Group, owning the Fluent UI React v9 component library and multiple GenUI solutions.
- Defined and executed the strategic roadmap for evolving the Fluent UI React v9 component library, championing a model-first design system approach and aligning it across engineering and partner experiences.
- Responsible for the team's OKRs, hiring, performance reviews and career development. Mentored and coached the team, supporting their growth, technical impact, and leadership within the Fluent UI ecosystem.
- Led cross-functional collaboration with Engineering, Product, Marketing, and Developer Relations to drive adoption, clarity of direction, and developer experience for Fluent UI.
- Multiple individual contributions, ranging from CI/CD improvements, documentation, and website tasks. Led the decision to adopt Astro as the website framework, becoming the first team at Microsoft to use it (<https://astro.build/case-studies/microsoft/>).
- Conducted research and hands-on experimentation with state-of-the-art LLM tooling, evaluating model capabilities, integrating agentic patterns, and fine-tuning models to fit the specific needs of Fluent UI and developer workflows.
- Built GenUI and agent-driven experiences that streamline how developers consume our library, integrating graph-augmented knowledge bases and AI-powered tooling across web, Teams, and MCP platforms.

Getir

Engineering Manager

April 2021 – December 2021

Cluj-Napoca, Romania

- Defined strategic roadmap for a team of 12 engineers, leading cross-functional collaboration and mentoring junior engineers.
- Managed and grew squads in the Algorithms Tribe, Infrastructure Alliance.
- Led infrastructure algorithms squads, delivering major initiatives to make real-time data feel real-time.
- Empowered and unblocked squads to deliver impact by establishing efficient execution and operational processes.
- Participated in and led software architecture decisions.
- Collaborated with other squads and tribes on cross-functional feature delivery.
- Planned and implemented monitoring systems to prevent service degradations and maintain high throughput.

- Guided team members in career growth, from onboarding to promotions, fostering long-term development.
- Led teams responsible for core business features, including order assignment and courier management.

Black Tree Software

Chief Technology Officer & Co-Owner

Sep 2012 – April 2021
Cluj-Napoca, Cluj, Romania

- Defined strategic roadmap for a team of 15 engineers, led cross-functional collaboration, and provided mentorship to junior engineers.
- Managed and led multiple engineering teams on various outsourcing projects.
- Drove the development of a sports betting and online gambling white-label PaaS with operations in three African countries (Ghana, Uganda, and Kenya).
- Designed and implemented the software architecture of the whole platform, creating a decoupled, highly scalable, micro-services based system.
- Worked alongside a DevOps team on designing and implementing a complete continuous integration / continuous delivery solution using the AWS cloud.
- Implemented machine learning data models for predicting and categorizing user activities / behaviors.
- Developed a lottery extraction tool which allowed the client to set a custom RTP (return to player) percentage using genetic algorithms.
- Worked with technologies ranging from low level code designed for currency detectors (ccTalk protocol) to full stack solutions (NodeJS, Python and React).

HiPPONET

Chief Technology Officer

Sep 2012 – Sep 2016
Cluj-Napoca, Cluj, Romania

- Managed a team of 6 developers on various outsourcing projects.
- Collaborated with Swedish company Penvision, developing a SaaS platform for online storage and processing of handwritten documents using proprietary handwriting recognition.
- Re-architected Rahmqvist's CRM tool for the Swedish market.
- Developed and published the Rahmqvist PIMNotes app for both Android and iOS

Wixi.com

Lead Engineer / Local Manager

Sep 2008 – Sep 2012
Cluj-Napoca, Cluj, Romania

- Managed the Cluj-Napoca office operations.
- Managed a team of 5 engineers building a file hosting service competing directly with Dropbox.
- Architected and implemented a full UI library with comparable window manager-like features in vanilla JS

OpenData

Software Engineer

Mar 2008 – Jul 2008
Cluj-Napoca, Cluj, Romania

- Designed and implemented a CRM tool for Cluj's largest real estate agency.

WebHorizon

Junior Software Engineer

Apr 2006 – Jul 2006
Cluj-Napoca, Cluj, Romania

- Worked on the Audi France website, developing components for both the client-facing site and back-office.

SKILLS

- Programming Languages: Python, Javascript, TypeScript, Rust, Golang
- Databases: Various db engines including both SQL and NoSQL solutions such as MongoDB, Redis, Couchbase, PostgreSQL.
- Web Servers: Nginx, Apache
- DevOps: Various DevOps tools and orchestration systems such as Kubernetes, Docker, Chef, Puppet, Terraform, Ansible., Worked on multiple cloud computing platforms including AWS, Azure and Google Cloud., Experienced with many CI tools such as CircleCI, GitLab, Jenkins, Azure Pipelines.
- Frontend: Various frontend frameworks / libraries such as React, Vue.
- Backend: Various backend frameworks based on NodeJS, Python and Rust.
- Machine Learning / AI: Various ML libraries such as TensorFlow, Keras and Brain.js., LLM tooling, agentic patterns, RAG, and model fine-tuning., GenUI and AI-powered developer experiences.
- Other: Strong algorithmic and data structures knowledge.

SIDE PROJECTS

Github profile Javascript, Python, Bash

<https://github.com/doidor>

Various open source projects that I personally use.

Random maze generator Javascript

A personal project that's designed to feed a multiplayer, mobile game with random generated maps, using a genetic algorithm and ranked by an A-star algorithm score in conjunction with a complexity index.